



GTX 760 for COD: AW

Activision listed out its min requirements for COD: Advanced Warfare, recommending GTX 760 or higher <http://dgit.in/CODActiv>



MSI upgrades all-in-ones

MSI's all-in-one gaming systems now have the latest GTX 970M and 980M mobile GPUs packed inside <http://dgit.in/MSIAllInOne>

on us, and whether you should encourage it. Wait, what? It must sound like we're joking, right? Why shouldn't anyone encourage social media? – Everyone you know is there, and it is THE place to get the lowdown on the latest in everything. Yeah well, it isn't as amazing as it sounds. There are several risks associated with being glued to our computers/mobiles in pursuit of social networking nirvana. Here are some arguments detailing why you should not be on social media.

Privacy? What's that?

Considering the amount of information we share, and on a public platform to boot, our lives are constantly on display for everyone to see. And as proven time and again, the internet isn't the safest place if we aren't careful. The need for privacy on social networking sites can be undermined by many factors including insufficient steps to adequately educate the user about the level of personal information being disclosed. Then, there's the issue of control over data. Information that's been removed by the user might just be retained and passed on to third parties – something similar to what social network Quechup did when it harvested email addresses of users for a spamming operation.

Cyberbullying, trolls and stalkers

As we've already established, a majority of social media users are youngsters, which in turn means that many parents and governments alike are extremely concerned about the misuse of social networks – specifically by sexual predators and cyber bullies. Social media provides the perfect platform for pedophiles to lure naïve young children into their trap. Profiles are viewable by everyone, and the victims' likes/dislikes can easily be found out by a poser trying to chat them up. Children wouldn't take the same amount of precautions online that the average adult would, and hence are extremely vulnerable to predators.

Cyber bullying/hate speech is the other main problem that kids and teenagers face online. Social networking sites allow individuals to freely express themselves

without any sort of filter and not worry about serious consequences for doing the same. The internet bestows a false sense of bravado on people giving them the courage to say things they wouldn't dare say in person. In this way, rumours are spread, and very rapidly at that, often causing groups to gang up on one another and terrorise individuals in front of their peers. Parents are often unaware of their children's predicament, and in the event that they do find out, the situation has already escalated and it's too late to help their kids. The devastation of these attacks can leave deep scars, and in several well publicised cases, victims have even been driven to suicide.

Professional vs. Personal: Where do you draw the line?

This is a dilemma that many of us face while sharing information online. "Do I really want my colleagues to know I was on a weekend getaway?" is the kind of question you often find yourself asking. The social media landscape is vast and can get intimidating for those who choose to mix their social and professional lives online. There have been numerous cases of employees losing jobs because their opinions painted their companies in bad



Those are IQ points flying away

light. For example, in April 2011, a bank employee was fired for making a sarcastic post about the higher salary of her boss with respect to hers. It can be quite tricky to achieve the right balance while posting personal information on social media sites without offending a colleague.

Sites like LinkedIn encourage workers to leave as big a social media footprint as possible in order to open up more opportunities in terms of career paths for them. However, doing this might in fact work against the user in terms of employability. Since the employers have access to their prospective employees' profiles, they can judge prospective candidates based on their social behavior. In fact, according to a survey conducted a couple of years ago, 1 in 10 people were rejected for a job because of their comments on an online profile. A similar number of candidates were rejected for posting inappropriate photos and/or content about drugs/alcohol. And though it may seem that most of the job opportunities lie online, a major chunk of job vacancies are never posted online. Therefore, expanding a social base on just the internet might be counterproductive in your pursuit for a job, if you aren't putting in the right amount of effort offline as well.

Psychological effects

Social networking has its fair share of psychological effects on regular users, which cover (but are not limited to):

- **Addiction:** The increasing usage of social networks has led researchers to study internet addiction as a very



Guess who's snooping? HR! That's who.